

Your name:

The UK Linguistics Olympiad 2020

Round 2



Solution and marking.

Marking (max 22)

- 1 point for each completely correct word. No half marks. (max 22)

a	hiseetewe? or ...owe?	b	oo3	c	coo3o?
d	coo3	e	coo3owe? or ...ewe?	f	hinenin
g	hineninewe? or ...owe?	h	wotooho	i	N/A
j	wo3onohoe	k	N/A	l	nii?eihii
m	nii?eihiiho?	n	nii?eihiihewe? or ...owe?	o	N/A
p	ce?ibexe?	q	benexo	r	N/A
s	benexe?	t	nesi	u	hisio
v	nesihewe?				

Commentary

Semantics

Nouns are classified as animate or inanimate semantically – note, body parts are inanimate, while “pine tree” and “car” are animate (all others are obvious).

Three of the examples (one’s older sister, one’s hand, one’s uncle) are possessed and contain a possessive prefix ne~hi.

Morphology

Stems

Nouns have two “stems”, S1 and S2, related by the following rules for going from S2 → S1:

	S1	←	S2
a.	-V		-Vh, -Vn, or -Vw
b.	-t		-tin
c.	-n		-nin
d.	-3		-t
e.	-x		-3
f.	-s		-x

All rules except (a.) can be performed in either direction. Another way of analysing the changes between S2 and S1 would be to assimilate many of the stem changes into a single

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"chain", as in: s -- x -- 3 -- t -- tin [if S2 ends in any of these, change to S1 by shifting one place to the left, on this chain], each step showing a kind of softening or reduction. The same reduction process would extend beyond the chain to Vh/n/w > V and nin > n. This process is similar to the 'soft mutation' of Welsh.

Inflectional rules

	singular	plural	obv. sing	loc sing
animate	S1	S2+o?	S1+o if S2= -h otherwise S2	S2+Vwe? V = o/e if stem contains o/e
inanimate	S1	S2+o	N/A	S2+e?

Note the limited vowel harmony in the locative singular. Note that this rule can be described, consistently with the data, in several consistent ways, including:

- if root contains e, then V = e
- else V = o

*Alternative solution: consistently with the data, this pattern can be explained as:

- V = e (for humans)
- V = o (for non-humans)

This alternate solution is not an actual rule in Arapaho, but since it fits the data given, it was scored identically, in both parts (R1 and R2), to the vowel harmony solution.

Possessive prefixes

The prefix "ne-" indicates possession (in English, "*my ..."). In the obviative singular, when this form exists (i.e., for animate nouns):

- ne- → hi-

(One way of explaining why this change happens is that the grammatical person is different in the obviative.)